GOVERNMENT POLICY DESIGN AND IMPLEMENTATION

DESIGN AGAINST IMPLEMENTATION → CLEARANCE-POINT ARITHMETIC → FRONTLINE DISCRETION → CONSULTATION AND EX-ANTE DESIGN → PUBLIC EXAMINATIONS ACT CARD → AIMS AGAINST SCOPE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◉ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ★ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g2 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 — DESIGN AGAINST IMPLEMENTATION

DESIGN AGAINST IMPLEMENTATION · DESIGN SIDE · PROBLEM DIAGNOSIS, TARGET POPULATION, INCENTIVE, REALISM AGAINST CAPACITY · IMPLEMENTATION SIDE · CLEARANCE POINTS, FRONTLINE DISCRETION, CITIZEN INTERFACE, REMEDY) · SYLLABUS RULE · THE CLAUSE NAMES BOTH, SO ANSWER IN TWO LABELLED · DESIGN REALISM MULTIPLIED BY CLEARANCE-POINT COUNT MULTIPLIED BY DISCRETION

CORE CLAIM

- DESIGN SIDE → problem diagnosis, target population, incentive, realism against capacity
- IMPLEMENTATION SIDE → clearance points, frontline discretion, citizen interface, remedy

MECHANISM

- SYLLABUS RULE → the clause names both, so answer in two labelled halves
- GAP → design realism multiplied by clearance-point count multiplied by discretion quality

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- MUST REMEMBER: Policy design proceeds through problem definition, evidence and…
- DESIGN SIDE → problem diagnosis, target population, incentive, realism against capacity

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SYLLABUS RULE → the clause names both, so answer in two labelled halves.

01

STAGE 01 — CLEARANCE-POINT ARITHMETIC

CLEARANCE-POINT ARITHMETIC · EACH APPROVAL · UNION, STATE, DISTRICT, PANCHAYAT SIGN-OFF ADDS AN INDEPENDENT POINT · CUMULATIVE FAILURE PROBABILITY RISES EVEN WHERE EVERY POINT IS · A SINGLE-AGENCY CENTRAL-SECTOR SCHEME CARRIES FEWER POINTS BY CONSTRUCTION · COST OF THE FIX · REMOVING POINTS CENTRALISES DECISIONS AND REDUCES LOCAL ADAPTATION

EACH APPROVAL → Union, state, district, panchayat sign-off adds an independent point → EFFECT → cumulative failure probability rises even where every point is separately likely → CONTRAST → a single-agency central-sector scheme carries fewer points by construction → COST OF THE FIX → removing points centralises decisions and reduces local adaptation

CORE CLAIM

- EACH APPROVAL → Union, state, district, panchayat sign-off adds an independent point
- EFFECT → cumulative failure probability rises even where every point is separately likely

MECHANISM

- CONTRAST → a single-agency central-sector scheme carries fewer points by construction
- COST OF THE FIX → removing points centralises decisions and reduces local adaptation

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- EACH APPROVAL → Union, state, district, panchayat sign-off adds an independent point
- EFFECT → cumulative failure probability rises even where every point is separately likely

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COST OF THE FIX → removing points centralises decisions and reduces local adaptation.

02

STAGE 02 — FRONTLINE DISCRETION

FRONTLINE DISCRETION · DID FRONTLINE ACTION MATCH THE ORIGINAL DESIGN · FRONTLINE OUTPUT IS THE REAL POLICY REGARDLESS OF DESIGN · COPING ROUTINES · RATIONING ATTENTION, CREAMING THE EASIER CASES, INFORMAL RULE-BENDING · EXPLAINS EXCLUSION ERROR WITHOUT ALLEGING CORRUPTION

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
TOP-DOWN → did frontline action match the original design	COPING ROUTINES → rationing attention, creaming the easier cases, informal rule-bending	TOP-DOWN → did frontline action match the original design
BOTTOM-UP → frontline output is the real policy regardless of design intent	PAYOFF → explains exclusion error without alleging corruption	BOTTOM-UP → frontline output is the real policy regardless of design intent

CORE CLAIM

- TOP-DOWN → did frontline action match the original design
- BOTTOM-UP → frontline output is the real policy regardless of design intent

MECHANISM

- COPING ROUTINES → rationing attention, creaming the easier cases, informal rule-bending
- PAYOFF → explains exclusion error without alleging corruption

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- TOP-DOWN → did frontline action match the original design
- BOTTOM-UP → frontline output is the real policy regardless of design intent

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COPING ROUTINES → rationing attention, creaming the easier cases, informal rule-bending.

03

STAGE 03 — CONSULTATION AND EX-ANTE DESIGN

CONSULTATION AND EX-ANTE DESIGN · PRE-LEGISLATIVE CONSULTATION POLICY, 2014, EXECUTIVE AND NOT STATUTORY · ORDINARY MINIMUM PUBLIC COMMENT PERIOD OF ABOUT THIRTY DAYS · DEPTH AGAINST COMPLIANCE · PUBLISHING A DRAFT IS NOT INCORPORATING FEEDBACK · REGULATORY IMPACT ASSESSMENT · EMERGING AND UNEVENLY INSTITUTIONALISED, NOT UNIFORMLY BINDING

POLICY → Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy, 2014, executive and not statutory

WINDOW → ordinary minimum public comment period of about thirty days → DEPTH AGAINST COMPLIANCE → publishing a draft is not incorporating feedback → REGULATORY IMPACT ASSESSMENT → emerging and unevenly institutionalised, not uniformly binding

CORE CLAIM

- POLICY → Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy, 2014, executive and not statutory
- WINDOW → ordinary minimum public comment period of about thirty days

MECHANISM

- DEPTH AGAINST COMPLIANCE → publishing a draft is not incorporating feedback
- REGULATORY IMPACT ASSESSMENT → emerging and unevenly institutionalised, not uniformly binding

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- POLICY → Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy, 2014, executive and not statutory
- WINDOW → ordinary minimum public comment period of about thirty days

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: REGULATORY IMPACT ASSESSMENT → emerging and unevenly institutionalised, not uniformly binding.

04

STAGE 04 — PUBLIC EXAMINATIONS ACT CARD

PUBLIC EXAMINATIONS ACT CARD · PUBLIC EXAMINATIONS (PREVENTION OF UNFAIR MEANS) ACT, 2024 · IN FORCE 21 JUNE 2024 BY NOTIFICATION S.O. 2422(E) · SCHEDULED AUTHORITIES · UPSC, SSC, RAILWAY RECRUITMENT BOARDS, IBPS, NTA, CENTRAL DEPARTMENTS · COVERAGE RULE · AUTHORITY-BASED; A STATE BOARD OR UNIVERSITY EXAMINATION IS NOT

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
STATUTE → Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024	SCHEDULED AUTHORITIES → UPSC, SSC, Railway Recruitment Boards, IBPS, NTA, Central departments	STATUTE → Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024
COMMENCEMENT → in force 21 June 2024 by notification S.O. 2422(E)	COVERAGE RULE → authority-based; a state board or university examination is not automatic	COMMENCEMENT → in force 21 June 2024 by notification S.O. 2422(E)

CORE CLAIM

- STATUTE → Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024
- COMMENCEMENT → in force 21 June 2024 by notification S.O. 2422(E)

MECHANISM

- SCHEDULED AUTHORITIES → UPSC, SSC, Railway Recruitment Boards, IBPS, NTA, Central departments
- COVERAGE RULE → authority-based; a state board or university examination is not automatic

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- STATUTE → Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024
- COMMENCEMENT → in force 21 June 2024 by notification S.O. 2422(E)

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COVERAGE RULE → authority-based; a state board or university examination is not automatic.

05

STAGE 05 — AIMS AGAINST SCOPE

AIMS AGAINST SCOPE · PREVENT AND PENALISE PAPER LEAKS, IMPERSONATION AND TAMPERING; PROTECT · SCHEDULED AUTHORITY, OR A CENTRAL GOVERNMENT NOTIFICATION, OR SEPARATE · READING TERRITORIAL EXTENT AS COVERAGE · ANSWER MOVE · ANSWER THE SCOPE HALF SEPARATELY AND EXPLICITLY

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
AIMS → prevent and penalise paper leaks, impersonation and tampering; protect credibility	ERROR → reading territorial extent as coverage	AIMS → prevent and penalise paper leaks, impersonation and tampering; protect credibility
SCOPE → scheduled authority, or a Central Government notification, or separate state law	ANSWER MOVE → answer the scope half separately and explicitly	SCOPE → scheduled authority, or a Central Government notification, or separate state law

CORE CLAIM

- AIMS → prevent and penalise paper leaks, impersonation and tampering; protect credibility
- SCOPE → scheduled authority, or a Central Government notification, or separate state law

MECHANISM

- ERROR → reading territorial extent as coverage
- ANSWER MOVE → answer the scope half separately and explicitly

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- AIMS → prevent and penalise paper leaks, impersonation and tampering; protect credibility
- SCOPE → scheduled authority, or a Central Government notification, or separate state law

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ANSWER MOVE → answer the scope half separately and explicitly.

06

STAGE 06 — SIX-STAGE IMPLEMENTATION MAP

SIX-STAGE IMPLEMENTATION MAP · 1 LEGAL AUTHORITY · ACT, RULE, GUIDELINE OR EXECUTIVE SCHEME, AND WHO IS · 2 RULES AND PROCEDURE · ENTITLEMENT, ELIGIBILITY AND PROCESS SPECIFIED · 3 AGENCY AND RESOURCES · NAMED RESPONSIBLE TIER; SANCTIONED AGAINST FILLED POSTS; FUND FLOW · 4 CITIZEN INTERFACE AND REMEDY

1 LEGAL AUTHORITY → Act, rule, guideline or executive scheme, and who is bound

2 RULES AND PROCEDURE → entitlement, eligibility and process specified → 3 AGENCY AND RESOURCES → named responsible tier; sanctioned against filled posts; fund flow → 4 CITIZEN INTERFACE AND REMEDY → awareness, documents, distance, language; appeal and review

CORE CLAIM

- 1 LEGAL AUTHORITY → Act, rule, guideline or executive scheme, and who is bound
- 2 RULES AND PROCEDURE → entitlement, eligibility and process specified

MECHANISM

- 3 AGENCY AND RESOURCES → named responsible tier; sanctioned against filled posts; fund flow
- 4 CITIZEN INTERFACE AND REMEDY → awareness, documents, distance, language; appeal and review

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- 1 LEGAL AUTHORITY → Act, rule, guideline or executive scheme, and who is bound
- 2 RULES AND PROCEDURE → entitlement, eligibility and process specified

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1 LEGAL AUTHORITY → Act, rule, guideline or executive scheme, and who is bound.

07

STAGE 07 — ASPIRATIONAL DISTRICTS DESIGN CARD

ASPIRATIONAL DISTRICTS DESIGN CARD · INTER-DISTRICT DIVERGENCE; 112 DISTRICTS UNDER NITI AAYOG · 49 KEY PERFORMANCE INDICATORS ACROSS FIVE NAMED THEMES · CONVERGENCE, COLLABORATION WITH THE PRABHARI OFFICER ARRANGEMENT, COMPETITION · SEPARATE UNIT · ASPIRATIONAL BLOCKS PROGRAMME COVERING 513 BLOCKS

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
UNIT → inter-district divergence; 112 districts under NITI Aayog	LEVERS → convergence, collaboration with the Prabhari officer arrangement, competition	UNIT → inter-district divergence; 112 districts under NITI Aayog
MEASUREMENT → 49 key performance indicators across five named themes	SEPARATE UNIT → Aspirational Blocks Programme covering 513 blocks	MEASUREMENT → 49 key performance indicators across five named themes

CORE CLAIM

- UNIT → inter-district divergence; 112 districts under NITI Aayog
- MEASUREMENT → 49 key performance indicators across five named themes

MECHANISM

- LEVERS → convergence, collaboration with the Prabhari officer arrangement, competition
- SEPARATE UNIT → Aspirational Blocks Programme covering 513 blocks

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- UNIT → inter-district divergence; 112 districts under NITI Aayog
- MEASUREMENT → 49 key performance indicators across five named themes

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SEPARATE UNIT → Aspirational Blocks Programme covering 513 blocks.

08

STAGE 08 — DELTA RANKING AND ITS LIMIT

DELTA RANKING AND ITS LIMIT · RANK ON THE PACE OF IMPROVEMENT RATHER THAN THE · THE HISTORICALLY WORST-OFF DISTRICT IS NOT PERMANENTLY BOTTOM AND · DASHBOARD DATA IS LARGELY DISTRICT-SELF-REPORTED WITH SELECTIVE VALIDATION · AN ADMINISTRATIVE-ATTENTION AND CONVERGENCE INSTRUMENT, NOT A FINANCING INSTRUMENT

CHOICE → rank on the pace of improvement rather than the absolute level → REASON → the historically worst-off district is not permanently bottom and unmotivated → LIMIT → dashboard data is largely district-self-reported with selective validation → READING → an administrative-attention and convergence instrument, not a financing instrument

CORE CLAIM

- CHOICE → rank on the pace of improvement rather than the absolute level
- REASON → the historically worst-off district is not permanently bottom and unmotivated

MECHANISM

- LIMIT → dashboard data is largely district-self-reported with selective validation
- READING → an administrative-attention and convergence instrument, not a financing instrument

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CHOICE → rank on the pace of improvement rather than the absolute level
- REASON → the historically worst-off district is not permanently bottom and unmotivated

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: READING → an administrative-attention and convergence instrument, not a financing instrument.

09

STAGE 09 — CONTRADICTION AS EXTERNALITY

CONTRADICTION AS EXTERNALITY · EACH MINISTRY OPTIMISES ITS OWN OBJECTIVE FUNCTION · NO SINGLE ACTOR IS ACCOUNTABLE FOR THE AGGREGATE ENVIRONMENTAL · THE ENVIRONMENTAL COST SITS IN NOBODY'S DEPARTMENTAL PERFORMANCE METRIC · SOME CONTRADICTIONS ARE VALUE CONFLICTS, NOT COORDINATION FAILURES · CLOSE DISTINCTION · POLICY, STATUTE, RULE, SCHEME, GUIDELINE, BUDGET AND ADMINISTRATIVE

MANDATES → each ministry optimises its own objective function → GAP → no single actor is accountable for the aggregate environmental outcome → MECHANISM → the environmental cost sits in nobody's departmental performance metric → QUALIFICATION → some contradictions are value conflicts, not coordination failures → CLOSE DISTINCTION: Policy, statute, rule, scheme, guideline, budget and administrative

CORE CLAIM

- MANDATES → each ministry optimises its own objective function
- GAP → no single actor is accountable for the aggregate environmental outcome

MECHANISM

- MECHANISM → the environmental cost sits in nobody's departmental performance metric
- QUALIFICATION → some contradictions are value conflicts, not coordination failures

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Policy, statute, rule, scheme, guideline, budget and administrative…
- MANDATES → each ministry optimises its own objective function

MECHANISM / VERDICT — CLOSE DISTINCTION: Policy, statute, rule, scheme, guideline, budget and administrative…

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Policy, statute, rule, scheme, guideline, budget and administrative.

10

STAGE 10 — COORDINATION AGAINST AUTHORITY

COORDINATION AGAINST AUTHORITY · PM GATISHAKTI · SHARED GEOGRAPHIC-INFORMATION-SYSTEM LAYER FOR MULTI-MODAL CONNECTIVITY · REMOVES SEQUENCING FAILURE AND LOWERS PRIVATE-SECTOR INFORMATION RISK · COORDINATES INFORMATION, NOT AUTHORITY OVER LAND, UTILITIES AND APPROVALS · PARTNERSHIP CHAIN · RISK ALLOCATION, COMPETITIVE PROCUREMENT, PERFORMANCE PAYMENT, EXIT RULES · EVIDENCE LIMIT

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
PM GATISHAKTI → shared geographic-information-system layer for multi-modal connectivity	LIMIT → coordinates information, not authority over land, utilities and approvals	EVIDENCE LIMIT: AUTHORITY / IMPLEMENTATION: Map Union, state, district, local body,…
GAIN → removes sequencing failure and lowers private-sector information risk	PARTNERSHIP CHAIN → risk allocation, competitive procurement, performance payment, exit rules	PM GATISHAKTI → shared geographic-information-system layer for multi-modal connectivity

CORE CLAIM

- PM GATISHAKTI → shared geographic-information-system layer for multi-modal connectivity
- GAIN → removes sequencing failure and lowers private-sector information risk

MECHANISM

- LIMIT → coordinates information, not authority over land, utilities and approvals
- PARTNERSHIP CHAIN → risk allocation, competitive procurement, performance payment, exit rules

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- EVIDENCE LIMIT: AUTHORITY / IMPLEMENTATION: Map Union, state, district, local body,…
- PM GATISHAKTI → shared geographic-information-system layer for multi-modal connectivity

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE LIMIT: AUTHORITY / IMPLEMENTATION: Map Union, state, district, local body,.

11

STAGE 11 — TARGETING AND ANSWER SPINE

TARGETING AND ANSWER SPINE · TIGHTER VERIFICATION LOWERS INCLUSION ERROR AND RAISES EXCLUSION ERROR · FIX THE TOLERABLE EXCLUSION ERROR FIRST FOR SUBSISTENCE ENTITLEMENTS · ONE ROUTED DEMAND SITS WITH THE BASIC OWNER; THREE · NAME THE STALLING STAGE, ATTACH ONE CORRECTIVE AND STATE

TRADE-OFF → tighter verification lowers inclusion error and raises exclusion error → RULE → fix the tolerable exclusion error first for subsistence entitlements; add assisted fallback → OWNERSHIP → one routed demand sits with the Basic owner; three sit with the Advanced → CLOSE → name the stalling stage, attach one corrective and state its cost

CORE CLAIM

- TRADE-OFF → tighter verification lowers inclusion error and raises exclusion error
- RULE → fix the tolerable exclusion error first for subsistence entitlements; add assisted fallback

MECHANISM

- OWNERSHIP → one routed demand sits with the Basic owner; three sit with the Advanced owner
- CLOSE → name the stalling stage, attach one corrective and state its cost

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- TRADE-OFF → tighter verification lowers inclusion error and raises exclusion error
- RULE → fix the tolerable exclusion error first for subsistence entitlements; add assisted fallback

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → fix the tolerable exclusion error first for subsistence entitlements; add assisted fallback.

E

EXTRA — SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · BOTTOM-UP THEORISTS WOULD ARGUE THE PUBLIC EXAMINATIONS ACT'S REAL · THE "CLEARANCE POINT" LOGIC EXPLAINS WHY CENTRALLY SPONSORED SCHEMES · LIPSKY'S "CREAMING" CONCEPT (FRONTLINE OFFICIALS FAVOURING EASIER-TO-SERVE · THE PRE-LEGISLATIVE CONSULTATION POLICY (2014) IS THE PRINCIPAL UNION-LEVEL · REGULATORY IMPACT ASSESSMENT REMAINS UNEVENLY INSTITUTIONALISED ACROSS INDIAN · THE PUBLIC EXAMINATIONS (PREVENTION OF UNFAIR MEANS) ACT, 2024 · CONVERGENCE COMMITTEES AT DISTRICT/PANCHAYAT LEVEL (SEE 12, 14) ARE

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- CAUTION: Bottom-up theorists would argue the Public Examinations Act's real test is not its
- CAUTION: The "clearance point" logic explains why centrally sponsored schemes requiring
- CAUTION: Lipsky's "creaming" concept (frontline officials favouring easier-to-serve
- The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy (2014) is the principal Union-level formulation

ADVANCED DEBATE

- CAUTION: Regulatory Impact Assessment remains unevenly institutionalised across Indian
- The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 itself illustrates
- CAUTION: Convergence committees at district/Panchayat level (see 12, 14) are the institutional
- CAUTION: Public healthcare marketisation (2024 PYQ, Q17): analytically, this is a design-stage

LEGACY / NUANCE

- CAUTION: Boundary case: a well-designed law that skips genuine stakeholder consultation (formal
- CAUTION: The Public Examinations Act's University/State Education Board coverage question (2024
- CAUTION: Reducing clearance points (faster, more centralised decision-making) can improve speed
- CAUTION: Granting street-level discretion allows humane adaptation to local circumstances but

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels